Me & My Old Man

meandmyoldman.co.uk | Neil Taylor, founder | For Katy Evans, catch up Friday 9 October

Katy, two years ago you sent me a spreadsheet of the leading national newspapers and the people to write to. It's where all of this started. Here is where I've got to and where I'm stuck.

WHERE THE BUSINESS IS

In two years: **37 families, 400 hours, 7 countries.** The objective now is to scale and reach more families, and PR's job is top of funnel: awareness.

Like most businesses, I track where my leads come from. A high percentage trace back to one shoutout from Josh Widdicombe on the Parenting Hell podcast (watch it here). The rest come from my warm network, referrals from past families, and inbound from my LinkedIn activity. One mention in front of the right audience works. I want more of them.

Podcasts. My appearances have gone well. They haven't led to sales, but they build credibility and fuel my content. Getting to the next level is the challenge: Gabby Logan's mid-life podcast, The Good Life Project, Fearne Cotton's podcast and Begin Again all feel reserved for celebrities.

THE ONE JOB

National media coverage. The idea: give a journalist the experience for free and let them write whatever they want about it. The next job is the Christmas gift lists, with Father's Day and Mother's Day behind them.

TWO STORIES I COULD PITCH

1. The core product: the Family Documentary. A 12 week experience. I interview the parent in guided sessions, I interview their children too, and I edit it all into ten chapters of that parent's life story, in their own words. The family then listens back together. It started with my dad: he died in March 2021, my son was born six days later, and I had never recorded his voice. Most families aren't broken, they've drifted. I once spent a whole twelve minute phone call with my mum talking about the dishwasher. See the Family Documentary here.

2. Grief: "Stories of those we've lost". A woman took her case to the Court of Session in Edinburgh to win the right to have children using her late husband's stored sperm. It made the Guardian and the BBC. Last year, with their two young children, she asked me to capture who he was. I interviewed his parents, his two brothers, three of his friends and her, and built an audio documentary with archive of his laugh and his silly guitar songs, so that when the children ask "what was Dad like", there is an answer. I have pitched the project to the Good Grief Festival as a talk, and I'm on their list. Hear how she felt about it here.

WHERE I'VE GOT TO

- **The Independent:** an editor replied and suggested the Christmas run-up. I have chased since, and it's gone cold.
- **The Guardian:** I wrote to journalists. No reply.
- **The Times:** ten journalists I want to write to, but I can't get their email addresses right.
- **Also:** Saga is sent, and I have two contacts at the i, one of whom said to keep in touch.

It feels like a fortress I can't get through.

WHAT I'D LOVE FROM YOU

1. **Direction.** Is giving the Family Documentary away the right idea? How, and who, do I pitch it to, and with what angle? The same question for grief.
2. **Outreach mechanics.** Is there an approach your teams follow? A LinkedIn connection, then three short emails over 10 days?
3. **Other routes to awareness.**
   Influencers. Through The Influencer Room I met one creator who was interested, but it didn't feel like the right fit. I've racked my brains for people with followings in my primary and secondary networks, with no luck. I would love someone like Jake Humphreys. I've followed and commented on his posts for months, and he did a great episode with Davina McCall on Begin Again about his parents.
   Events. I have a list of TEDx events for the next 18 months, and a list of events and conferences that touch on parenting, mid-life, family and cancer. All of it is new territory for me, and I would love to get on stage.

IF YOU WANT MORE

Website | My story | Testimonials | FAQ | Podcasts | BBC interview